

FEDERAL SYSTEM

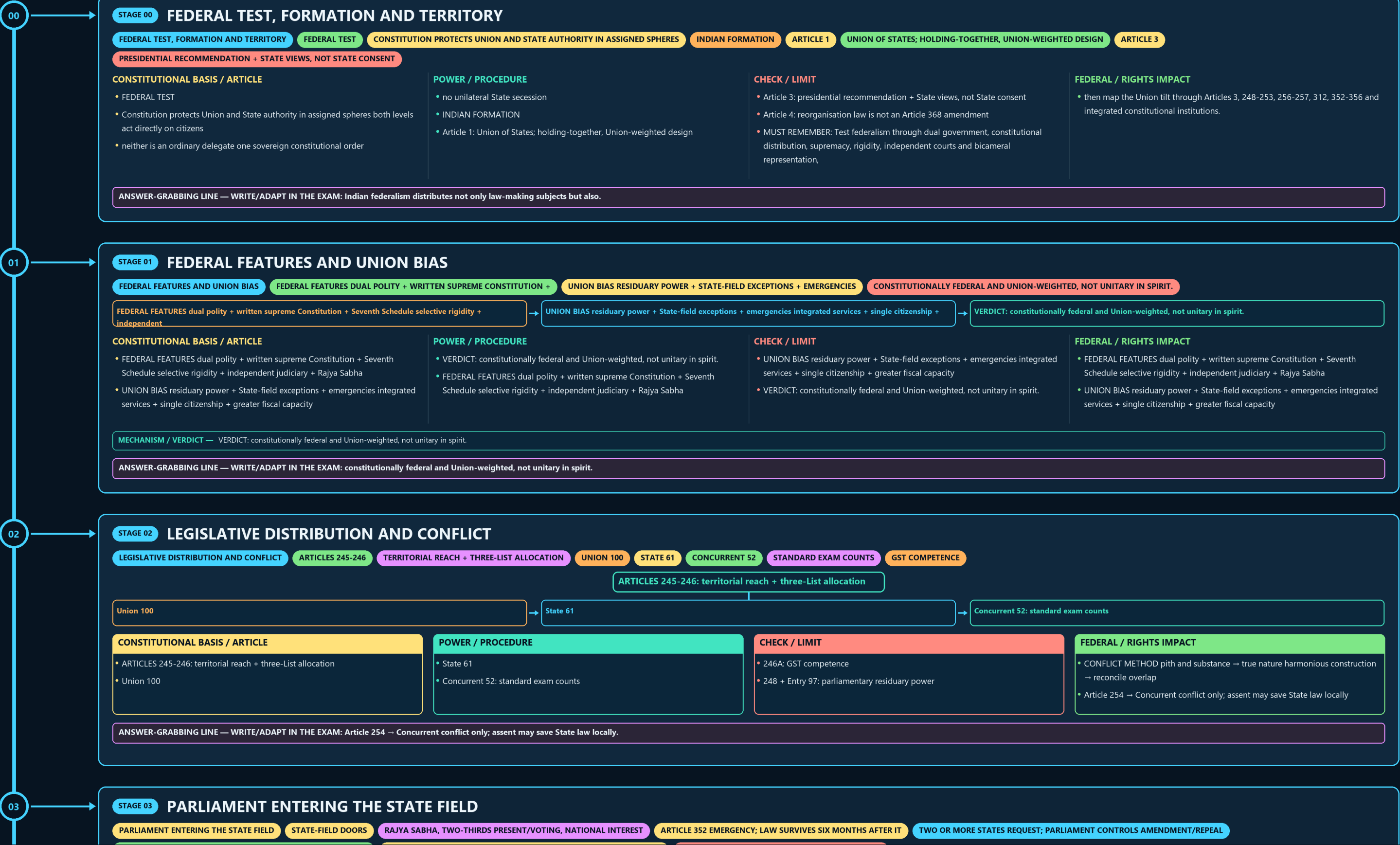
FEDERAL TEST, FORMATION AND → FEDERAL FEATURES AND UNION → LEGISLATIVE DISTRIBUTION AND CONFLICT → PARLIAMENT ENTERING THE STATE → ADMINISTRATIVE RELATIONS → FINANCIAL DISTRIBUTION AND FISCAL

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g8 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

ARTICLES 248 + 249: PARLIAMENTARY RESIDUARY POWER: STATE-BOUNDED

• Union 100

ARTICLE 251

• Concurrent 52: standard exam counts

ARTICLE 351: COMPOUNDING

• 248 + Entry 97: parliamentary residuary power

CONCURRENT 52: PARLIAMENTARY RESIDUARY POWER: STATE-BOUNDED

→ reconcile overlap

• Article 254 → Concurrent conflict only; assent may save State law locally

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 254 → Concurrent conflict only; assent may save State law locally.

03

STAGE 03

PARLIAMENT ENTERING THE STATE FIELD

PARLIAMENT ENTERING THE STATE FIELD

STATE-FIELD DOORS

RAJYA SABHA, TWO-THIRDS PRESENT/VOTING, NATIONAL INTEREST

ARTICLE 352 EMERGENCY; LAW SURVIVES SIX MONTHS AFTER IT

TWO OR MORE STATES REQUEST; PARLIAMENT CONTROLS AMENDMENT/REPEAL

TREATY IMPLEMENTATION; STILL SUBJECT TO THE CONSTITUTION

AFFECTED STATE DURING PRESIDENT'S RULE; S.R. BOMMAI (1994) REVIEW

NO GENERAL UNION POWER TO LEGISLATE ON LIST II.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• STATE-FIELD DOORS

• 249: Rajya Sabha, two-thirds present/voting, national interest

POWER / PROCEDURE

• 250: Article 352 Emergency; law survives six months after it ends

• 252: two or more States request; Parliament controls amendment/repeal

CHECK / LIMIT

• 253: treaty implementation; still subject to the Constitution

• 356-357: affected State during President's Rule; S.R. Bommai (1994) review

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• TRAP: no general Union power to legislate on List II.

• STATE-FIELD DOORS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: no general Union power to legislate on List II.

04

STAGE 04

ADMINISTRATIVE RELATIONS

ADMINISTRATIVE RELATIONS

ARTICLES 256-257 SECURE COMPLIANCE AND PREVENT IMPEDANCE OF UNION

RECIPROCAL DELEGATION

UNION FUNCTIONS

STATE WITH CONSENT

STATE FUNCTIONS

UNION WITH UNION CONSENT

261 FULL FAITH/CREDIT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• ARTICLES 256-257 secure compliance and prevent impedance of Union executive power directions are text-bounded, not a general administrative takeover

• RECIPROCAL DELEGATION

POWER / PROCEDURE

• 258: Union functions → State with consent

• 258A: State functions → Union with Union consent

CHECK / LIMIT

• 261 full faith/credit

• 262 water-dispute law

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• 263 Inter-State Council

• ARTICLES 256-257 secure compliance and prevent impedance of Union executive power directions are text-bounded, not a general administrative takeover

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 261 full faith/credit | 262 water-dispute law | 263 Inter-State Council.

05

STAGE 05

FINANCIAL DISTRIBUTION AND FISCAL AUTONOMY

FINANCIAL DISTRIBUTION AND FISCAL AUTONOMY

FISCAL CONSTITUTION

LEVY, COLLECTION, ASSIGNMENT AND IGST APPORTIONMENT

DIVISIBLE POOL

275 AND 282

DISTINCT GRANT ROUTES

FINANCE COMMISSION REPORT

CONDITIONAL BORROWING CONSENT

FISCAL CONSTITUTION

→ 268/269/269A: levy, collection, assignment and IGST apportionment

→ 270: divisible pool

→ 275 and 282: distinct grant routes

→ 280-281: Finance Commission report

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• FISCAL CONSTITUTION

• 268/269/269A: levy, collection, assignment and IGST apportionment

• 270: divisible pool

• 275 and 282: distinct grant routes

POWER / PROCEDURE

• 280-281: Finance Commission report

• 293: conditional borrowing consent

• 16TH FINANCE COMMISSION report submitted 17 Nov 2025

• award 2026-31

CHECK / LIMIT

• States: 41% vertical share; exact horizontal weights need official report

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: Article 1's 'Union of States' rejects a secession compact but does not make

• India unitary.

• Federalism is basic structure

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• the Union may be stronger and States territorially alterable while each level retains constitutionally assigned fields.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: India unitary. Federalism is basic structure; the Union may be stronger and States territorially alterable while each level retains constitutionally assigned fields.

06

STAGE 06

BASIC STRUCTURE AND EMERGENCY CONTROL

BASIC STRUCTURE AND EMERGENCY CONTROL

CASE CHAIN

WEST BENGL (1962)

NO SOVEREIGN-STATE COMPACT

KESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973)

LIMITED AMENDMENT POWER

S.R. BOMMAI (1994)

FEDERALISM BASIC STRUCTURE; ARTICLE 356 REVIEW

CASE CHAIN

West Bengal (1962): no sovereign-State compact

→ Kesavananda Bharati (1973): limited amendment power

→ S.R. Bommai (1994): federalism Basic Structure; Article 356 review

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• CASE CHAIN

• West Bengal (1962): no sovereign-State compact

POWER / PROCEDURE

• Kesavananda Bharati (1973): limited amendment power

• S.R. Bommai (1994): federalism Basic Structure; Article 356 review

CHECK / LIMIT

• DUTY != REMEDY

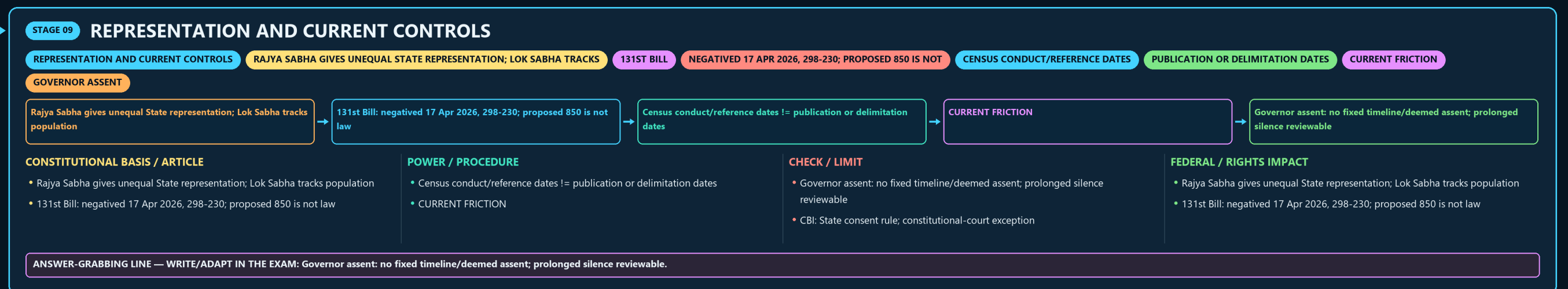
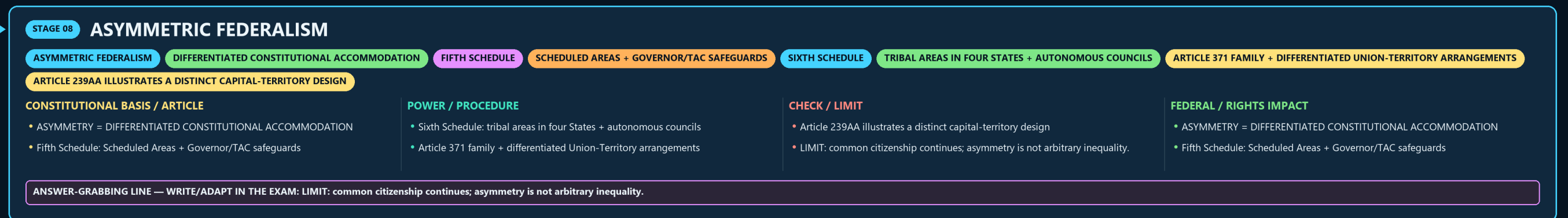
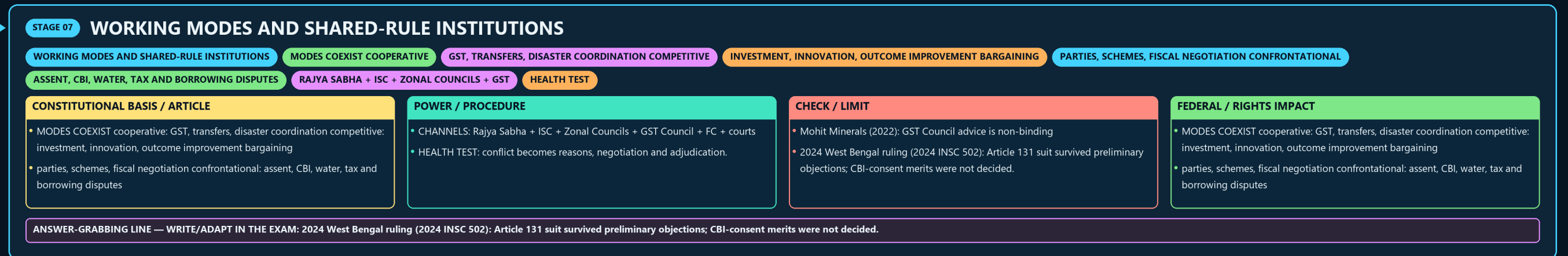
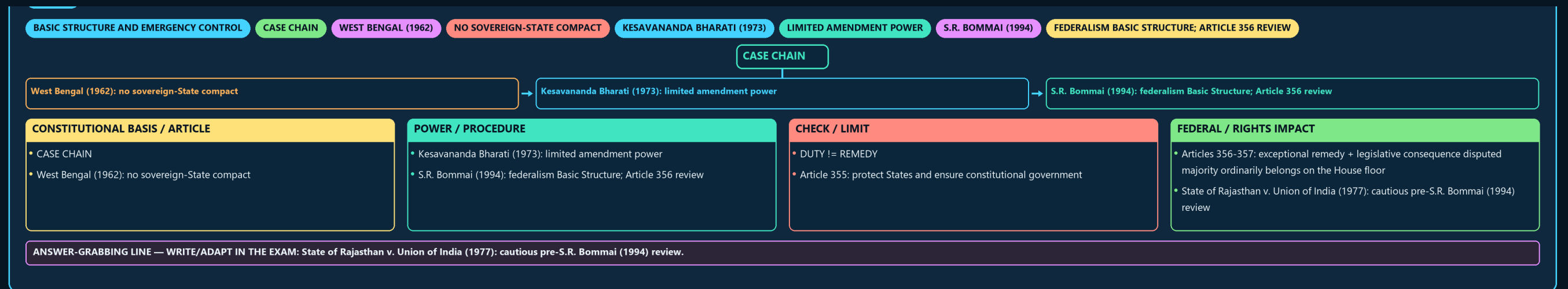
• Article 355: protect States and ensure constitutional government

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• Articles 356-357: exceptional remedy + legislative consequence disputed majority ordinarily belongs on the House floor

• State of Rajasthan v. Union of India (1977): cautious pre-S.R. Bommai (1994) review

FEDERAL SYSTEM • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2660-5894 of 11214 • continues below



- Rajya Sabha gives unequal State representation; Lok Sabha tracks population
- 131st Bill: negatived 17 Apr 2026, 298-230; proposed 850 is not law

- Census conduct/reference dates != publication or delimitation dates
- CURRENT FRICTION

- Governor assent: no fixed timeline/deemed assent; prolonged silence reviewable
- CBI: State consent rule; constitutional-court exception

- Rajya Sabha gives unequal State representation; Lok Sabha tracks population
- 131st Bill: negatived 17 Apr 2026, 298-230; proposed 850 is not law

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Governor assent: no fixed timeline/deemed assent; prolonged silence reviewable.

10

STAGE 10
VERIFIED PYQS AND PRELIMS TRAPS

VERIFIED PYQS AND PRELIMS TRAPS TEN ROUTES MODES + CENTRALISING LAWS CBI + FEDERAL ESSENCE PARTY INCENTIVES ARTICLE 356 + GST + PRISONS CENTRE-STATE TRUST FISCAL FEDERALISM

TEN ROUTES

2020: modes + centralising laws → 2021: CBI + federal essence → 2022: party incentives

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- TEN ROUTES
- 2020: modes + centralising laws
- 2021: CBI + federal essence

POWER / PROCEDURE

- 2022: party incentives
- 2023: Article 356 + GST + prisons
- 2024: Centre-State trust

CHECK / LIMIT

- 2025: fiscal federalism
- Article 254 is Concurrent-specific
- 262 exclusion needs parliamentary law

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Article 355 is not automatic 356
- GST recommendations are non-binding
- State competence is autonomous, not sovereign

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 355 is not automatic 356 | GST recommendations are non-binding.

11

STAGE 11
MARKS-SCALED ANSWER SPINE

MARKS-SCALED ANSWER SPINE 10 MARKS ONE ARTICLE CLUSTER ONE CASE 15 MARKS ADD MECHANISMS NAMED EVIDENCE SPECIFIC REFORM

10 MARKS: define → one Article cluster → one case → qualified verdict → 15 MARKS: add mechanisms → named evidence → counterpoint → specific reform → 20 MARKS: integrate asymmetry + representation + current control → graded verdict → MASTER SPINE definition → allocation → administration/finance → operation → evidence → limitation → reform → conclusion

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- 10 MARKS: define → one Article cluster → one case → qualified verdict
- 15 MARKS: add mechanisms → named evidence → counterpoint → specific reform
- 20 MARKS: integrate asymmetry + representation + current control → graded verdict

POWER / PROCEDURE

- MASTER SPINE definition → allocation → administration/finance → operation → evidence
- limitation → reform → conclusion
- VERDICT: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy through consultation and restraint.

CHECK / LIMIT

- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Current federal claims must distinguish enacted law, advisory judgments and
- failed proposals: the 2025 Article 143 opinion controls assent, the 16th Finance
- Commission retains 41 percent vertical devolution, and the defeated 131st Amendment Bill,

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 2026 never amended the Constitution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy through consultation and restraint.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy through consultation and restraint.

E

EXTRA
SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT 14. ADVANCED CLASSIFICATIONS AND SCHOLARS - OPTIONAL [ANALYSIS] THE 2022 GS-II PROPOSITION IS BROADLY PLAUSIBLE AS NATIONAL PARTIES CONTROLLING THE UNION MAY PREFER UNIFORMITY AND COUNTEREVIDENCE MATTERS

NATIONAL PARTIES DEMAND AUTONOMY WHEN IN STATE OPPOSITION REGIONAL PARTIES CAN CENTRALISE WITHIN THEIR STATES COALITION GOVERNMENTS LED BY NATIONAL PARTIES STRENGTHENED STATE BARGAINING.

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- 14. Advanced classifications and scholars - optional
- [ANALYSIS] The 2022 GS-II proposition is broadly plausible as an incentive pattern, not an ideological law.
- National parties controlling the Union may prefer uniformity and central leverage; regional parties may seek fiscal and administrative autonomy.
- Counterevidence matters: national parties demand autonomy when in State opposition

ADVANCED LIMIT

- regional parties can centralise within their States
- coalition governments led by national parties strengthened State bargaining.
- Best verdict: institutional location and electoral incentives often explain federal preference better than party label alone .
- Advanced classifications and scholars - optional Scholar toolkit | Scholar / label | Use | Limit | ---|---| K.C.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Political federalism: party competition, coalition arithmetic and regional parties can decentralise or centralise actual power without textual amendment.
- Executive federalism: much coordination occurs among executives and officials, which can improve speed but weaken legislative transparency.
- Multi-level federalism: local governments complicate a simple Union-State binary even though Parts IX and IX-A do not create co-equal sovereign units.
- Dialogic federalism: councils, commissions, courts and elections create repeated exchanges rather than one final allocation of every dispute.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.